

MA388 Sabermetrics: Lesson 8

How many runs is a win? - Part II

LTC Jim Pleuss

```
library(tidyverse)
library(Lahman)
library(knitr)
library(ggrepel)
library(broom)
```

Review

In our last lesson, we discussed the following model:

$$Wins_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 RD_i + \epsilon_i \quad \epsilon_i \sim \text{Normal}(0, \sigma^2)$$

where $Wins_i$ and RD_i are the wins and run differential for team i .

Interpret the coefficients in this model.

Pythagorean Models

Discuss limitations for the regression model above.

Here are three models:

$$Wpct = \beta_0 + \beta_1 RD + \epsilon \tag{1}$$

$$Wpct = \frac{R^2}{R^2 + RA^2} + \epsilon \tag{2}$$

$$Wpct = \frac{R^k}{R^k + RA^k} + \epsilon \tag{3}$$

where $Wpct$ is Win Percentage, R is Runs Scored, RA is Runs Allowed, and ϵ is the random error. Recall that we fit Model 1 to the 1997-2001 seasons.

Briefly discuss the strengths/limitations of each model.

How would you assess which model is the best? Please be specific.

Model 2: Pythagorean Formula (Bill James)

First, let's create a function to calculate the expected wins under a Pythagorean Formula.

```
# Function to calculate expected wins using Pythagorean formula.
# Arguments:
# R - runs scored
# RA - runs allowed
# k - exponent
# Value Returned:
# expected win percentage

pyth_wins <- function(R, RA, k = 2){
  return(R^k/(R^k + RA^k))
}
```

Using Model 2, let's calculate the expected number of wins for each team (1997-2001).

```
my_teams = Teams |>
  filter(yearID >= 1997, yearID <= 2001) |>
  mutate(RD = R - RA,
         Wpct = W/(W+L),
         Wpct_pyth2 = pyth_wins(R,RA,2))
```

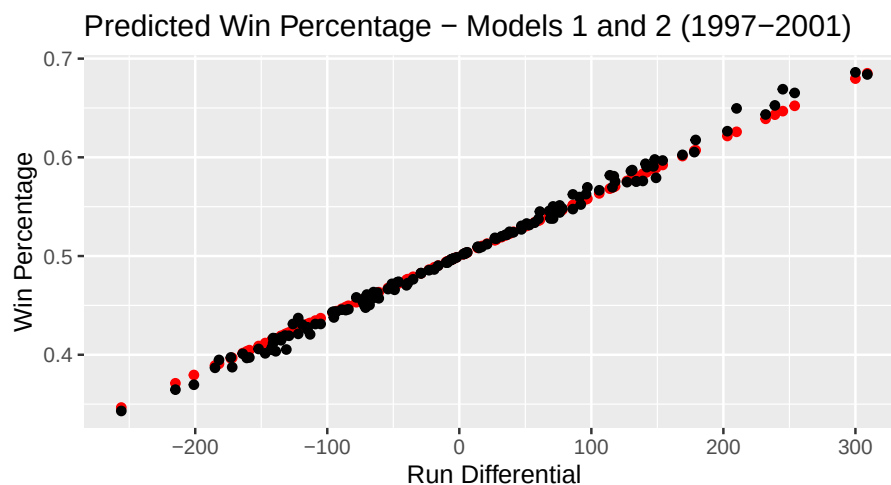
Next, let's compare graphically the predictions from Model 1 and 2.

```
# Get predicted win percentages from Model 1.

lin_fit <- lm(Wpct ~ RD, data = my_teams)
my_teams <- augment(lin_fit, data = my_teams)

# Plot Model 1 and Model 2 predictions.

my_teams |>
  ggplot(aes(x = RD, y = .fitted)) +
  geom_point(col = "red") +
  # geom_point(aes(x = RD, y = Wpct)) +
  geom_point(aes(x = RD, y = Wpct_pyth2)) +
  labs(x = "Run Differential",
       y = "Win Percentage",
       title = "Predicted Win Percentage - Models 1 and 2 (1997-2001)")
```



```
summary(lin_fit)
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = Wpct ~ RD, data = my_teams)
```

Residuals:

	Min	1Q	Median	3Q	Max
	-0.063492	-0.014889	0.001682	0.014852	0.060984

Coefficients:

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)

```
(Intercept) 5.000e-01 1.888e-03 264.85 <2e-16 ***
RD          5.994e-04 1.662e-05 36.06 <2e-16 ***
---
Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 0.02297 on 146 degrees of freedom
Multiple R-squared:  0.8991,    Adjusted R-squared:  0.8984 
F-statistic: 1301 on 1 and 146 DF,  p-value: < 2.2e-16
```

Briefly discuss how the models differ.

Next, let's compare the root mean square error (RMSE). Write an equation for the RMSE.

```
# Model 1 RMSE
sqrt(mean(my_teams$.resid^2))
```

```
[1] 0.0228099
```

```
# Note this is very close to the Residual Standard Error you could obtain from the model.
summary(lin_fit)$sigma
```

```
[1] 0.02296561
```

```
# Model 2 RMSE
# Calculate residuals.
my_teams = my_teams |>
  mutate(.resid_pyth2 = Wpct - Wpct_pyth2)
# Calculate RMSE for Model 2
sqrt(mean(my_teams$.resid_pyth2^2))
```

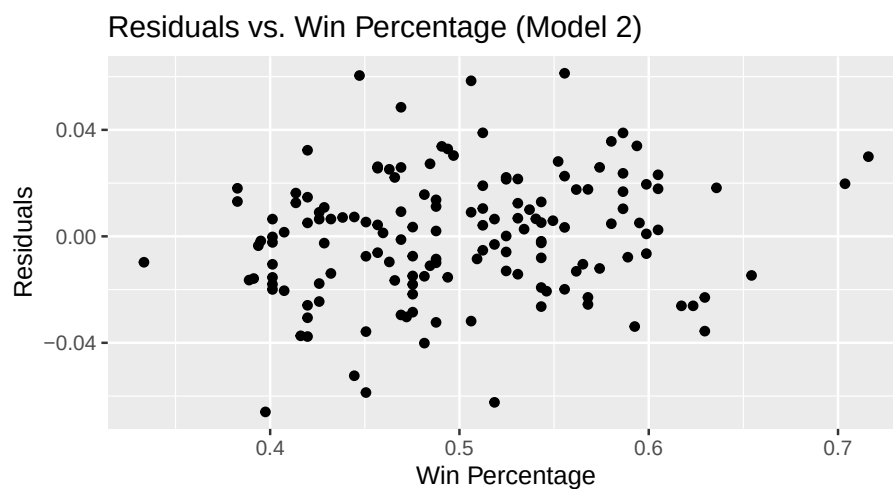
```
[1] 0.023058
```

Next, let's take a look at the residuals from Model 2.

```
# Let's look at a summary of the residuals (min, max, mean, and quartiles).
my_teams |>
  pull(.resid_pyth2) |>
  summary()
```

Min.	1st Qu.	Median	Mean	3rd Qu.	Max.
-0.0659548	-0.0153919	0.0014263	-0.0001182	0.0158258	0.0612624

```
my_teams |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Wpct,
             y = .resid_pyth2)) +
  geom_point() +
  labs(x = "Win Percentage", y = "Residuals",
       title = "Residuals vs. Win Percentage (Model 2)")
```



Next, let's try Model 3.

How do we find an estimate of k in Model 3?

```
my_teams = my_teams |>
  mutate(logWratio = log(W/L),
         logRratio = log(R/RA))

# Including 0 in formula means we don't include an intercept.
pythFit <- lm(logWratio ~ 0 + logRratio, data = my_teams)
pythFit
```

```
Call:
lm(formula = logWratio ~ 0 + logRratio, data = my_teams)
```

```
Coefficients:
logRratio
      1.904
```

Why don't we want an intercept in this model? (Warning: this is very unusual!)

```
k = pythFit$coefficients[1]

# Get predictions.
my_teams = my_teams |>
  mutate(Wpct_pyth_k = pyth_wins(R,RA,k = k))

# Get residuals.
my_teams = my_teams |>
  mutate(.resid_pyth_k = Wpct - Wpct_pyth_k)

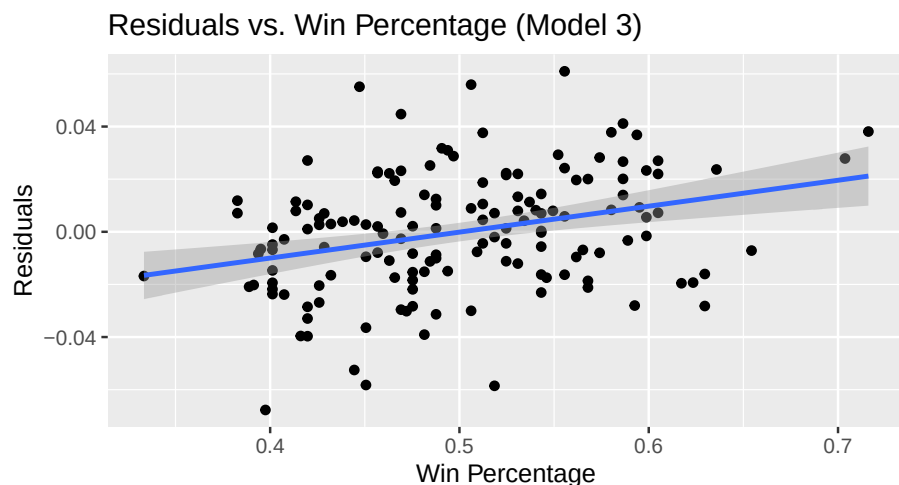
# Calculate RMSE.
sqrt(mean(my_teams$.resid_pyth_k^2))
```

```
[1] 0.02279093
```

```
my_teams |>
  pull(.resid_pyth_k) |>
  summary()
```

Min.	1st Qu.	Median	Mean	3rd Qu.	Max.
-0.0677086	-0.0162629	0.0011648	-0.0001293	0.0139919	0.0609875

```
my_teams |>
  ggplot(aes(x = Wpct,
             y = .resid_pyth_k)) +
  geom_point() +
  labs(x = "Win Percentage", y = "Residuals",
       title = "Residuals vs. Win Percentage (Model 3)") +
  geom_smooth(method = "lm")
```



```
my_teams |>
  lm(.resid_pyth_k ~ Wpct, data = _) |>
  summary()
```

Call:

```
lm(formula = .resid_pyth_k ~ Wpct, data = my_teams)
```

Residuals:

	Min	1Q	Median	3Q	Max
	-0.060232	-0.013571	0.001806	0.013704	0.060461

Coefficients:

	Estimate	Std. Error	t value	Pr(> t)
(Intercept)	-0.04941	0.01261	-3.917	0.000137 ***
Wpct	0.09857	0.02497	3.947	0.000122 ***

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Residual standard error: 0.02181 on 146 degrees of freedom

Multiple R-squared: 0.09643, Adjusted R-squared: 0.09024

F-statistic: 15.58 on 1 and 146 DF, p-value: 0.0001225

How many runs for a win? (pg. 106)

Previously, we learned about the “10-for-1” rule of thumb (number of required runs scored for one additional win) using Model 1. Using Model 2, this quantity

changes based on runs allowed. How can we find an expression for the number of required runs scored for one additional win?

Let's explore this for various combinations of runs scored and runs allowed. (Note R and RA below are runs scored per game and runs allowed per game.)

```
# Function to compute incremental runs per win.
IR <- function(R = 5, RA = 5){
  (R^2 + RA^2)^2 / (2*R*RA^2)
}

ir_table <- expand.grid(R = seq(3,6,0.5),
                       RA = seq(3,6,0.5))

ir_table |>
  mutate(IRW = IR(R,RA)) |>
  spread(key = RA, value = IRW, sep = "=") |>
  round(1)
```

	R	RA=3	RA=3.5	RA=4	RA=4.5	RA=5	RA=5.5	RA=6
1	3.0	6.0	6.1	6.5	7.0	7.7	8.5	9.4
2	3.5	7.2	7.0	7.1	7.5	7.9	8.5	9.2
3	4.0	8.7	8.1	8.0	8.1	8.4	8.8	9.4
4	4.5	10.6	9.6	9.1	9.0	9.1	9.4	9.8
5	5.0	12.8	11.3	10.5	10.1	10.0	10.1	10.3
6	5.5	15.6	13.4	12.2	11.4	11.1	11.0	11.1
7	6.0	18.8	15.8	14.1	13.0	12.4	12.1	12.0

How do the results of Model 2 compare to Model 1 (the “10-for-1” model) in terms of incremental runs per win?